

How to Identify the Ideal Customer Profile

An EWOR Checklist

An ideal customer profile (ICP) defines the type of customer that's most likely to get strong value from your product, convert into a paying account, and stay with you over time. Your first ICP typically starts with observable factors like industry and company size, then evolves as you learn from real customer behaviour and purchase patterns.

ICP works like a filter: when a prospect engages with your product or content, you compare them to your ICP to decide whether they match the customers you most want to win.

But ICP isn't useful as a static line in a spreadsheet, it's a practical input that powers your go-to-market. Used well, ICP sharpens targeting across marketing, sales, customer success, and product—improving lead quality, speeding up qualification, and increasing retention and ROI. It also aligns teams on whom to pursue and what “qualified” actually means. To help you get started, we made this guide outlining the steps to build an ICP you can actually use.

Step 1

Identify Your ICP

This step is about starting your ICP with evidence, not opinions. Before you pick industries, company sizes, or job titles, you gather objective signals from the market—who already buys solutions like yours, what problems they're actively trying to solve, and where demand is strongest. The goal is to replace assumptions with a clear baseline you can build on.

• Collect Objective Market Data

Start with market research focused on the customer side of the mirror—not your product. Write down the key questions you need answered, then use the market (customers, competitors, reviews, existing data) to find clear, objective signals to shape your first ICP.

Market Data Collection	
How big is the market size?	How?
% of the market captured so far?	Industry reports, market research
Who are the top customers?	Industry reports, competitor analysis
How satisfied are the customers?	Analytics, customer reviews
Level of customer awareness?	Customer reviews & feedback, monitor SM
	Monitor SM, brand tracking studies

• Narrow Down the Basic ICP Characteristics

Turn your research into a simple fit filter using observable company traits:

- Industry
- Geography
- Business Type
- Stage/age
- Tech Stack
- Company Size

This becomes your baseline profile for which accounts to prioritise.

• Specify Unique ICP Qualifiers

Go beyond basics and define the traits that predict real fit and buying intent:

- Revenue
- Company Work Style
- Investment
- Pain Point
- Goal
- Budget
- Where Users Spend Time

Step 2

Build User and Buyer Personas

A user persona describes the day-to-day user. This includes their workflow, pain points, and what success looks like in the product. A buyer persona describes the person who approves or funds the purchase—their decision criteria, perceived risks, and what they need to justify spending. For both, define:

- Team Department
- Team Size
- Job Title/Role
- Specific Role Description
- Role in Buying Process
- Team Stack (CRM, CSM, etc.)
- Pain Point
- End Goal

Step 3

Test and Validate Initial ICP

Your ICP is a working hypothesis so test and validate it with real results for 1–6 months. Track signals like conversion/win rate, time-to-value, product usage, NPS/satisfaction, LTV, and quality inbound demand.

If performance is weak, don't panic. Study your best customers instead of noisy leads, look for shared traits, and compare metrics across segments to refine your ICP.

Step 4

Refine Your ICP

Once you've identified your best customers and your most successful deals, use them as your source of truth. This step is about spotting the patterns behind accounts that bought faster, adopted deeper, renewed longer, and were happiest—then updating your ICP so your GTM focuses on more of those customers.

📍 The Value of best customers

Best customers give you two things at once: data (usage, retention, expansion, time-to-value) and feedback (clearer language, sharper pains, real-world constraints). Combine both to refine what “fit” actually means.

• Run a Quick Positioning Debrief on Your Best Deals:

Start with market research focused on the customer side of the mirror—not your product. Write down the key questions you need answered, then use the market (customers, competitors, reviews, existing data) to find clear, objective signals to shape your first ICP.

Positioning Debrief

Capture the insights you need to further develop your ICP.

✔ What were their goals?

✘ What were their pains points?

🔄 Why did they choose us over alternatives?

🔄 Why did they choose my product over alternatives?

📈 What outcomes have customers in our ICP achieved?

Step 5

Identify Intent Signals

Your ICP tells you who to focus on; intent signals tell you who is ready now. This step is about spotting behaviours and trigger events that indicate a real likelihood to adopt and buy, then using those signals to prioritise outreach, qualify leads, and allocate time to the accounts most likely to convert. Done well, intent signals also help you refine your ICP by revealing which “fit” accounts actually move — and why. Be sure to track:

- Brand Interactions
- Product Usage
- Feature Signals
- Team Adoption
- Onboarding Completion
- Integrations
- Company Triggers (e.g. rapid hiring, new leadership, etc.)
- Decision-Maker Involvement
- High-Intent Actions (e.g. booking demos)
- Proof-Seeking Behaviour (e.g. viewing case studies or review sites)

📍 Tip

Not every signal is relevant for every business — choose the few that consistently correlate with activation and purchase for your product, and treat them as extra “weight” on top of ICP fit.



Useful Tools

Tools and generators for data enrichment, ICP profiles in your CRM, buying-pattern analysis, and social listening/market research.



Hubspot

Combines your marketing, sales, and service teams together on the same AI-powered customer platform. EWOR Fellows get a discount!



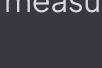
Intercom

Intercom is the next-generation customer service platform, built for an AI-first world.



Pipedrive

Manage your sales, track leads, organise deals, use AI insights, and automate so you can spend more time selling.



Salesforce

Unify your apps, data, and AI to help your teams act faster, support customers 24/7, and drive measurable ROI.



HockeyStack

Combines marketing, sales, and product data for multitouch attribution, buyer-journey visibility, and AI insights to improve spend and revenue.



Gong

AI operating system for revenue teams — built to hit targets, close with confidence, and keep growth rolling deal after deal, quarter after quarter.



Clearbit

Enrich your CRM with real-time company and contact data to personalise outreach and improve lead scoring and routing.



Mixpanel

Event-based product analytics for web and mobile apps to improve engagement and retention with funnels and segmentation.



UserMotion

Predictive sales intelligence that uses real-time product usage signals to prioritise leads and spot accounts likely to buy, expand, or churn.



Hootsuite

A social tool to schedule and monitor posts, track ROI, and manage multichannel content from one dashboard to support pipeline.



G2

B2B software marketplace and review platform that helps buyers compare tools using millions of verified peer reviews and ratings.



ZoomInfo

B2B data platform with verified contact and company data, technographics, and intent signals to find and convert ideal customers.

ICP Key Point Checklist

Put it altogether in this sheet [here](#).

- [] Gather objective market signals
- [] Narrow your ICP using core firmographics
- [] Add key qualifiers that predict strong fit
- [] Define user and buyer personas
- [] Validate your ICP over 1–6 months
- [] Study your best customers (best customers)
- [] Compare win rate, LTV, and NPS by segment
- [] Identify intent signals
- [] Update your ICP using feedback + data from successful deals